

Sports Toolkit

Horse riding · Tennis · Basketball — key words and what the coach will say

Over the week you'll do horse riding, tennis, and basketball with English-speaking coaches. This sheet gives you the core words for each sport, plus the instructions coaches actually use — so you understand them straight away, even before we've studied the sport in class. Keep it with you and look at it whenever you like.

Horse riding

20 key words

Word	Meaning
horse / pony	the animal you ride
saddle	the seat on the horse's back
reins	the straps you hold to guide the horse
stirrups	where you put your feet
helmet	protects your head — always worn
bridle	the straps around the horse's head
mount	to get on the horse
dismount	to get off the horse
groom	to clean and brush the horse
hoof	the horse's foot

Word	Meaning
mane	the hair on the horse's neck
halter	rope/strap used to lead the horse
walk	the slowest pace
trot	faster than a walk, bumpier
canter	faster than a trot, smoother
gallop	the fastest pace
halt	to stop
rider	the person on the horse
instructor	the person who teaches you
arena	the fenced area where you ride

What the coach will say

- "Mount from the left side."
- "Hold the reins with both hands." (*one in each hand*)
- "Heels down, look up!" (*good riding position*)
- "Sit up straight."
- "Squeeze with your legs to go forward."
- "Walk on." (*start moving*)
- "Trot on."
- "Pull gently to halt." (*stop*)
- "Give him a pat." (*thank the horse at the end*)
- "Well done!"

Tennis

20 key words

Word	Meaning
racket	what you hit the ball with
ball	the small yellow ball
net	divides the court in two
court	the playing area
serve	the shot that starts a point
forehand	hit with your palm facing forward
backhand	hit across your body
volley	hitting the ball before it bounces
ace	a serve nobody can return
fault	a serve that lands outside the box

Word	Meaning
deuce	a tied score (40-40)
love	zero points
baseline	the back line of the court
rally	several shots back and forth
bounce	when the ball hits the ground
grip	how you hold the racket
swing	the movement of your arm and racket
footwork	how you move your feet
opponent	the player you play against
match point	the point that wins the match

What the coach will say

- "Watch the ball."
- "Turn your shoulder."
- "Bend your knees."
- "Follow through." (*finish the swing*)
- "Split step." (*a small jump before you move*)
- "Toss the ball higher." (*when serving*)
- "Get ready!"
- "Your serve."
- "Change ends."
- "Good shot!"

Basketball

20 key words

Word	Meaning
ball	the orange ball
hoop / basket	where you score
court	the playing area
dribble	bouncing the ball as you move
pass	throwing the ball to a teammate
shoot	throwing the ball at the hoop
rebound	catching the ball after a missed shot
foul	illegal contact with another player
free throw	an uncontested shot after a foul
three-pointer	a shot from far away, worth 3 points

Word	Meaning
defense	trying to stop the other team scoring
offense	trying to score
team-mate	a player on your team
pivot	turning on one foot while holding the ball
layup	a close-range shot near the basket
jump ball	how the game starts
travel	a violation — moving without dribbling
score	the number of points, or to get points
guard	to defend a player closely
block	to stop a shot with your hand

What the coach will say

- "Dribble with your fingertips, not your palm."
- "Keep your head up."
- "Pass the ball!"
- "Bend your knees before you shoot."
- "Follow through with your wrist."
- "Get back on defense!"
- "Box out." (*position yourself for the rebound*)
- "Switch!" (*change who you're defending*)
- "Your ball." (*your turn / your possession*)
- "Nice shot!"